

Loss of Beard Big Blow to Tribe but Everyone's Happy

By LESTER KOELLING
News Sportswriter

CHARLESTON—"All I can say is, there is no better place in the minors than Indianapolis."

That was Ted Beard's farewell speech in Louisville last night, an hour before he hopped a plane for New York to join the Chicago White Sox,

and moments after he helped the Indians to an 8-0 victory over the Colonels.

In typical Beard fashion, his remarks were few and his response extremely shy to the back-slapping, hand-shaking and words of wisdom from his joyous teammates. Joyous over losing the heart of a ball club?

Indeed, the Indians never were happier. They knew what it meant to Beard, in the twilight of his career at 36 years. And they all love Teddy.

"Andy, it's been a pleasure." That was Beard's farewell to Manager Andy Cohen. The rest of the time Teddy was catching rather than pitching.



Koelling

"Remember, don't talk so much, talking gets you in trouble," chided Vince Garcia.

"Teddy, you've taken all the smiles off the pitchers' faces," countered Roy Tinny, who jokingly followed with "Remember, us pitchers gave you an assist to the majors. We made you a star."

Other suggestions of "Be yourself up there," and "Remember your buddies in the minors" and "Give 'em hell" trailed Teddy as he stepped out the door under a great ovation to a grand little guy.

So Beard is gone and Dom Di Tusa is being recalled from Tulsa. But it won't be the same without Teddy in center field. He leaves a void there and in the ranks of the Indians. But no matter how much anyone will miss him, no one can deny that anyone

is more deserving of another shot in the big time.

The scene in the clubhouse somehow was reminiscent of that night in September, 1948, after the Indians had clinched the pennant. They told Ted he was going to Pittsburgh, and his teammates were happy for him then, too. But not Teddy.

He cried. He didn't want to leave "the boys with whom I helped to win a pennant." Finally, when convinced that he had to go to the majors, Teddy meekly said: "Well, if I have to go there is just one thing I would like to ask. May I take along a couple of my bats?"

Ted's tenure with Indianapolis actually started in 1947. He was with the club for the first month of the season but made only one official trip to the plate. After his promotion in '48, Beard came back to the Indians for most of the 1949 season.

He never has spent an entire season in the majors, being with Pittsburgh part-time from 1948-52. In 1953 he was with Hollywood and the next two years with San Francisco, the club from which the Indians bought him in the winter of 1955.

Ted's farewell contribution with the Indians was three hits in five trips, to boost his season average to .347. He will miss the opportunity to win the league batting championship, but a contract with the White Sox means much more. In Ted's greatest season he was the bulwark of the Indianapolis club and many might agree that he was even better than in 1948.

The indelible record that Beard leaves behind includes, in addition to the top batting mark in the league, a total of 121 hits, 20 doubles, 12 triples, 10 homers and 11 stolen bases. All hail to Beard, and may Manager Al Lopez see fit to play Little Mighty regularly in which way Teddy will do the White Sox the most good.

Last night's game in Louisville, the last this season for the Indians, featured Barry Latman in a four-hit shutout, the second of his 3-year career. But Barry was in trouble every inning, yielding seven walks in addition to the hits.

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